

OFFICIAL PROGRAMME

Merge Film Festival 2026



1–4 October 2026

MASSAGNO

Thursday

1 OCTOBER 2026

One evening on the big screen.

20:30

20:30–23:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM

CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–

Opening ceremony · Memory of Princess Mumbi

The festival opens and the film begins immediately afterwards in the same auditorium. One ticket for the whole evening.

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.
Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.
Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Friday

2 OCTOBER 2026

Private school masterclasses and workshops, the first two competition programmes, the discussion and the Swiss awards.

09:00	09:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Schools only Masterclass for arts high schools · Antonella Autuori (SUPSI)						
10:00	10:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Out of competition · WALL·E Andrew Stanton, Pixar, 2008 · 98 min.						
13:30	13:30–15:30 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Schools only Masterclass for science high schools · Stefano Peduzzi (SUPSI)						
13:30	13:30–15:30 · MASSAGNO MIDDLE SCHOOLS Schools only Workshops for middle schools Luca Botturi (SUPSI), Christian Montecchiani (SUPSI), Elena Battipede (SUPSI), Petra Mazzoni (SUPSI).						
14:00	14:00–15:30 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– In competition · Programme 1 Seven short films, ≈ 60 min. Followed by a Q&A with the directors in person.						
17:00	17:00–18:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Free admission FORMA APERTA · Where does the creative process live? Open talk and launch of FORMA APERTA, with Felix Bachmann, Kevin Merz, Manuela Bachmann and Simona Gamba.						
18:30	18:30–20:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Free admission Screening & Conversation with Alessandro Bavari Cronache di Mare WORLD PREMIERE						
	<table> <tr> <td>Artefatti</td><td>Raw War</td></tr> <tr> <td>The Freakpoint Range</td><td>UNKNOWN QUANTUM OBJECTS</td></tr> <tr> <td>Moderated by Dario Cirrincione.</td><td></td></tr> </table>	Artefatti	Raw War	The Freakpoint Range	UNKNOWN QUANTUM OBJECTS	Moderated by Dario Cirrincione.	
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The Freakpoint Range	UNKNOWN QUANTUM OBJECTS						
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20:45	20:45 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Included with the Programme 2 ticket Swiss Innovator Award by Swiss AI Weeks · Swiss Press Award by linkfloyd						
21:00	21:00–22:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– In competition · Programme 2 Six short films, ≈ 60 min., with a Q&A with the directors in person.						
18:00	18:00–01:00 · MASSAGNO Free admission Piazza del festival · Food and drinks						

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Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.
Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Saturday

3 OCTOBER 2026

The busiest day: three competition programmes, a roundtable, a panel on the environmental impact of AI, a talk and the Critics' Award.

10:00	10:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Out of competition · Wider than the Sky Valerio Jalongo, 2025 · 83 min.	CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–
10:00	10:00–11:30 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Roundtable · How is the image changing? With Alessandro Bavari and Marco Longo · CISA and USI.	Free admission
13:30	13:30–15:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM In competition · Programme 3 Eight short films, ≈ 60 min. Followed by a Q&A with the directors in person.	CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–
14:00	14:00–15:00 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Roundtable · Work and the role of human beings in the age of artificial intelligence In English. With Marco Zaffalon, Colin Porlezza (USI), Javisth Chabria and Pierre Alexandre Tremblay. Screening of The Interview by Mark Wachholz. Moderated by Felix Bachmann. In collaboration with USI.	Free admission
15:30	15:30–17:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM In competition · Programme 4 Eight short films, ≈ 60 min. Followed by a Q&A with the directors in person.	CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–
16:00	16:00–17:00 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Panel: The environmental impact of AI In English. With Prof. Silvia Santini (USI), Dr Marta Soprana (LSE IDEAS) and Elettra Fiumi. Moderated by Ilaria Espa.	Free admission
17:30	17:30–19:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Talk · Javisth Chabria and Kevin B. Lee (USI) In English. Moderated by Felix Bachmann. In collaboration with USI.	Free admission
21:00	21:00–22:30 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Critics' Award by Filmexplorer and In competition · Programme 5 Seven short films, ≈ 60 min., with a Q&A with the directors in person.	CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–
10:00	10:00–01:00 · MASSAGNO Piazza del festival · Food and drinks	Free admission

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Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.

Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Sunday

4 OCTOBER 2026

Awards ceremony, followed by the screening of the winning films.

15:00

15:00–16:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM

CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–

Awards ceremony and screening of the winning films

The awards are presented, immediately followed by a screening of the winning films.

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.
Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.
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